Every BP555 control, explained

One slide per button, switch and dial: what it is, where it is, what it does, which machines have it and the mistake to avoid.



Supplied by **Cotswold Packaging Group**
Based on the Better Packages 555e User Manual, Rev 3.1

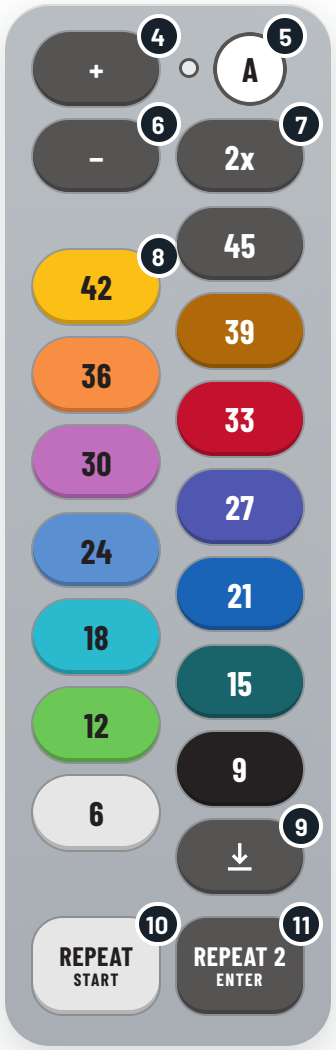
The eleven controls



1 Main Power Switch

2 Heater Control Dial

3 Water Level Slider, right side of the tank



4 + add half an inch

5 A Automatic Mode and its red light

6 – take off half an inch

7 2x double

8 14 length buttons

9 hold to feed

10 REPEAT START

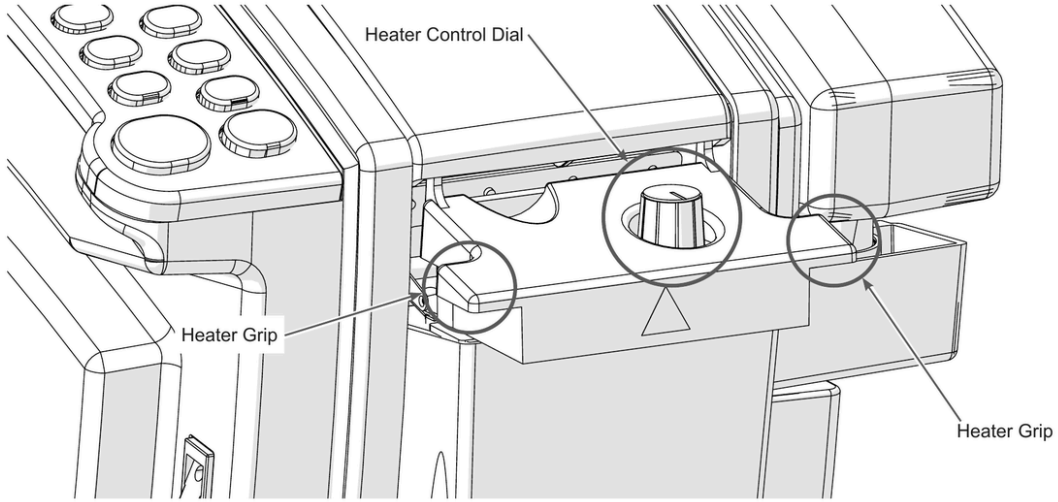
11 REPEAT 2 ENTER

1 Main Power Switch



TYPE	Rocker switch
WHERE	Lower front panel, below the keypad
DOES	**I** is on. **O** is off.
YOU HEAR	A beep once the machine has started up and is ready to use.
MODELS	All
WATCH OUT	Switching off wipes any Automatic Mode program. If there is no beep at a working socket, call for service.

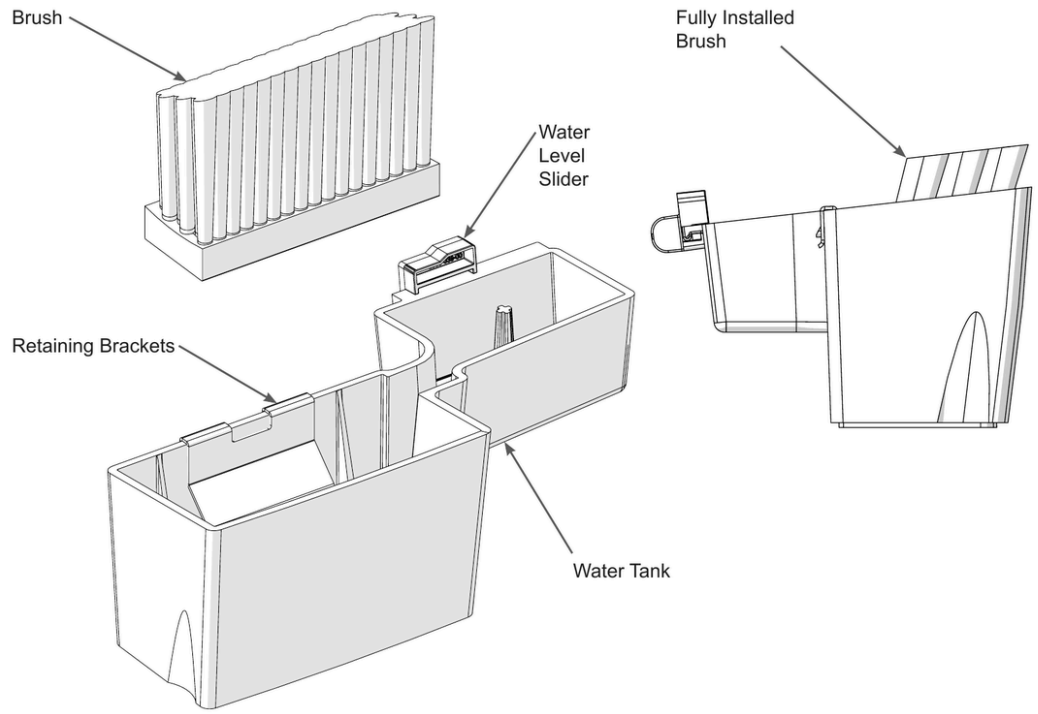
2 Heater Control Dial



Manual, Figure 23.

TYPE	Rotary knob
WHERE	On top of the heater, above the water tank
DOES	Sets the heat. Marked OFF, five dots, then MAX. Leaves the factory on OFF.
YOU SEE	The dial position. Some machines have a limiter that stops it turning past a set point.
MODELS	All. Every 555e uses the same heater.
WATCH OUT	In a heated or climate-controlled building, halfway is enough and the heater lasts longer. The underside is hot: handle it by the grip tabs, or wait 30 minutes.

3 Water Level Slider



Manual, Figure 19.

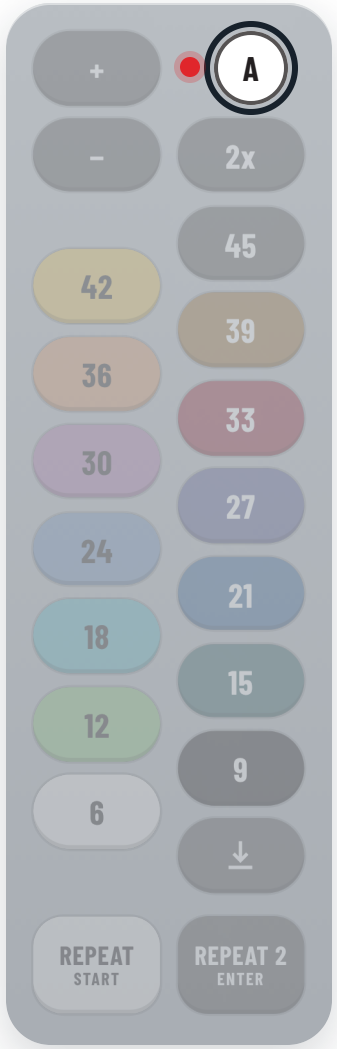
TYPE	Sliding tab
WHERE	Right side of the water tank
DOES	Towards the machine raises the water level and wets the tape more. Away from the machine lowers it.
YOU SEE	Properly wet tape feels oily and pulls strings of glue when two wet pieces are pulled apart.
MODELS	All
WATCH OUT	Too low gives tacky, dry tape that will not bond. Too high gives watery tape that slips and sets slowly.

4 Plus



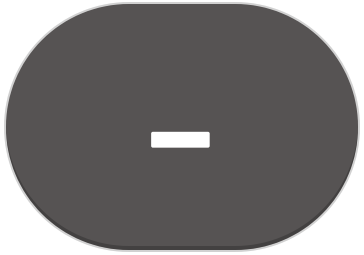
TYPE	Keypad button
WHERE	Top left of the keypad
DOES	Adds half an inch (13 mm) to the length you press next. Twice adds one inch.
EXAMPLE	+ → 24 gives 24.5 in. + → + → 24 gives 25 in.
MODELS	All
WATCH OUT	Press it **before** the length button. The length button dispenses straight away.

5 A and the Automatic Mode light



TYPE	Keypad button with a red indicator light beside it
WHERE	Top right of the keypad
DOES	First press turns Automatic Mode on. Next press turns it off and returns to normal use.
YOU SEE AND HEAR	A beep, and the light next to (A) glows red while Automatic Mode is on.
MODELS	Automatic models only `eSA eLA eMA eFA eJA`
WATCH OUT	Pressing (A) to turn it off also wipes the stored lengths.

6 Minus



TYPE Keypad button

WHERE Second row, left, under +

DOES Takes half an inch (13 mm) off the length you press next. Twice takes off one inch.

EXAMPLE − → 24 gives 23.5 in. − → − → 24 gives 23 in.

MODELS All

WATCH OUT Same rule as plus: adjustment first, then the length.

7 Double



TYPE Keypad button

WHERE Second row, right, under (A)

DOES Doubles the length you press next. Gets you past 45 inches.

EXAMPLE 2x → 24 gives 48 in.

\+ → + → + → 2x → 24 gives 49.5 in.

MODELS All

WATCH OUT Plus and minus are added after the doubling. Three presses of + with 2x still add 1.5 inches, not 3.

8 Length buttons



TYPE 14 colour-coded keypad buttons

WHERE Two columns down the middle of the keypad

DOES Press one and that length is wetted, fed out and cut straight away.

MODELS Standard and automatic: 6 to 45 in. `eL` 12 to 90 in. `eM eMA eJ eJA` 15 to 145 cm.

WATCH OUT Choose any **+**, **–** or **2x** first.

9 Random



TYPE	Keypad button, marked with a down arrow
WHERE	Bottom of the right-hand column, under 9
DOES	Feeds tape for as long as you hold it down. Let go and it stops.
USE IT FOR	An odd length you have no button for. In Automatic Mode it can be one of the stored lengths.
MODELS	All
WATCH OUT	It does not stop by itself. Release it when you have enough tape.

10 REPEAT START



Normal use

Feeds the last length you dispensed again. One press per carton when you are sealing a run of the same size.

In Automatic Mode

Starts the stored program. The first length feeds out, and each piece after that comes out when you tear the last one off.

WHERE Bottom left of the keypad, the large light grey key

MODELS All

11 REPEAT 2 ENTER



Normal use

Feeds the second-to-last length you dispensed. Useful when you alternate between two carton sizes.

In Automatic Mode

Stores the length you just dispensed. Press it after each piece you want in the program, up to three.

WHERE Bottom right of the keypad, the large dark grey key

MODELS Automatic models only `eSA eLA eMA eFA eJA`

Lookup table

CONTROL	WHAT IT DOES	MODELS
Main Power Switch	**I** on, **O** off. Beeps when ready. Off clears Automatic Mode.	All
Heater Control Dial	OFF, five dots, MAX. Halfway is enough indoors.	All
Water Level Slider	Towards the machine for wetter tape, away for drier.	All
+	Adds half an inch to the next length. Press before the length.	All
–	Takes half an inch off the next length. Press before the length.	All
2x	Doubles the next length.	All
6 to 45	Feeds that length straight away.	All
↓	Feeds tape while held.	All
REPEAT START	Last length again. In Automatic Mode, runs the program.	All
REPEAT 2 ENTER	Second-to-last length. In Automatic Mode, stores a length.	Automatic
A and red light	Automatic Mode on and off. Off clears the program.	Automatic